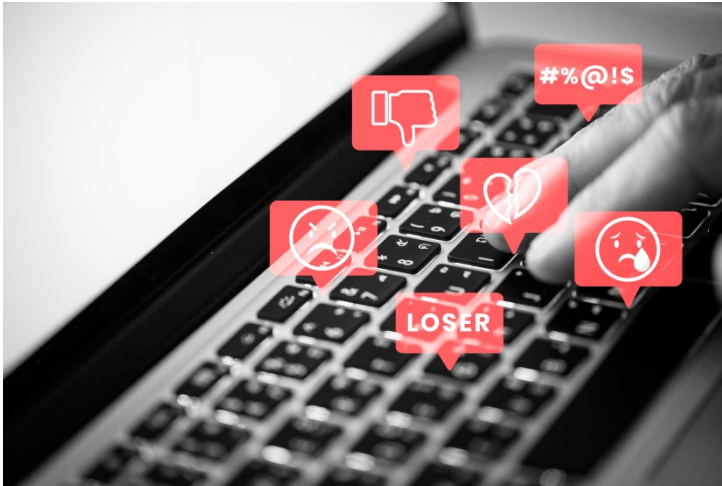


UNIT 4

DIGITAL CITIZENSHIP



Connect to the topic

1. Look at the photo.
What is happening in the picture?
2. How do you think the person receiving these messages might feel?
3. Why do some people feel more comfortable being rude or mean online?
4. How can you protect yourself from cyberbullies?
5. How can we make the internet a kinder place?

WARM-UP VIDEO

WATCH AND SPECULATE. Watch the video about the digital citizenship and discuss the questions below.

1. What does it mean to be a digital citizen?
2. What is a digital footprint? How does it affect people in the long term?
3. How can you spot fake news or unreliable online information?
4. How does a digital footprint influence job opportunities, education, or personal relationships?
5. Does digital citizenship look different in different countries? Why?
6. Should social media influencers be responsible for promoting good online behavior?



UNIT 4.1 NETIQUETTE

READING AND VOCABULARY

Task 1. READ FOR DETAILS. Read the text and decide if the statements below are True or False.

Netiquette in Team Chats for Coding Projects

In today's digital workspaces, how we talk to each other matters just as much as the code we write. Team chats, whether on Slack, Microsoft Teams, Discord, or GitHub Discussions, are where most collaboration happens, so learning how to **maintain** respectful communication really pays off both for productivity and team spirit.

One simple rule? Keep your messages **concise**. No one wants to scroll through a massive block of text just to find one suggestion. Break things down and use **threads** to keep ideas grouped. That way, when someone's checking bug reports or reviewing **pull requests**, they don't waste time trying to figure out what reply goes where.

Another thing that trips people up is **tone awareness**. Without voice or body language, even a neutral message can come off as rude. It's better to write "Could you take a look at this when you have time?" instead of something like "Fix this." Emojis can help, but, yes, use them sparingly. This isn't a meme group chat.

Using **@mentions** **responsibly** is another big one. Sure, tagging someone gets their attention fast, but overdoing it is just plain **distracting**. And not everyone's online at the same time. That's why many teams rely on **status indicators** (things like "In a meeting" or "Focus time") to avoid unnecessary pings.

And when it comes to code? Keep **code snippets** short and clean. Don't paste the whole file, just enough to show the issue. If it's longer, use version control websites and link to them. That saves everyone time.

Finally, feedback. It's tempting to just say what's wrong and move on, but that's not helpful. Better to say "This is a great start. Have you thought about trying it this way?" Comments like that **encourage** teamwork instead of shutting people down.

(adapted from <https://algotcademy.com/blog/34-effective-communication-skills-for-remote-coding-teams/>)

- | | |
|--|--------------|
| 1. Team chats are considered outdated tools in modern coding projects. | True / False |
| 2. One rule of netiquette is to keep your messages short and clear. | True / False |
| 3. Threads and reply chains help organize team discussions. | True / False |
| 4. It's recommended to say "Fix this" when asking someone to change code. | True / False |
| 5. Emojis should be avoided completely in professional team chats. | True / False |
| 6. Not everyone on a coding team may be available at the same time. | True / False |
| 7. Using @mentions too much can distract team members. | True / False |
| 8. Posting full code files directly in chat is encouraged for better teamwork. | True / False |
| 9. Code snippets should be readable and may include comments. | True / False |
| 10. Constructive feedback helps build trust and improves collaboration. | True / False |

Task 2. WORK WITH WORDS. Look at the **highlighted** words in the text and match them with their definitions.

1. maintain	a) understanding how your words may sound or feel to others
2. concise	b) small icons or texts that show if someone is available or busy
3. threads	c) in a careful and controlled way
4. pull requests	d) asking to review code changes before adding to the main project

5. tone awareness	e) keep something in good condition or working order over time
6. responsibly	f) promote or give support to something
7. distracting	g) short and clear, giving only necessary information
8. status indicators	h) short pieces of code shared to explain or solve a specific point
9. code snippets	i) causing someone to lose focus or concentration
10. encourage	j) parts of conversation grouped by topic in a chat

Task 3. WORK WITH WORDS. Use the words from previous task to fill in the gaps.

- To keep the chat clean, developers post code in _____ instead of full files.
- A respectful tone and polite phrases show good _____ in digital communication.
- He gave clear, _____ feedback that helped solve the issue faster.
- During coding sessions, unnecessary messages can be _____ to team members.
- Always use @mentions _____ – don't tag the whole team unless it's urgent.
- The team created _____ to separate bug discussions from design talks.
- Before merging new features, developers create _____ on GitHub.
- A healthy team environment _____ collaboration and trust.
- Good online behavior _____ a positive team dynamic.
- Developers check their teammates' _____ before asking a question.

Task 4. WORK WITH WORDS. Fill in the words from the box into the text below.

Don't Be That Person

boundaries ▪ typing delay ▪ off-topic ▪ nudge ▪ ALL CAPS ▪ overpost
▪ tone-deaf ▪ flaming ▪ lurking ▪ ghosting

We've all been in those online study chats that feel... chaotic. You open your group platform, and boom – 50 unread messages, most of them 1) _____. Someone's sending memes, another is talking in 2) _____, and the one person who actually asked a question? Ignored.

Let's be real – netiquette matters. If you want your online group to actually get stuff done (and not crash and burn), a few digital manners go a long way.

First off: don't 3) _____. It's cool to contribute, but spamming the chat with "just one more thought" every five seconds? Not helping. And 4) _____ (posting angry or rude replies) never ends well. You might think you're being honest, but it just kills the vibe and scares people off.

Speaking of scaring people off: no one likes 5) _____. If you're dropping out of a project or just need a break, let the group know. Silence can be confusing. On the flip side, don't panic if there's a 6) _____ – people are busy, or maybe just thinking. Be chill.

Then there's 7) _____. Look, it's fine to observe for a bit, but don't just sit there silently forever. Give your opinion, even if it's just "Looks good to me." A simple comment shows you're present.

Also: be courteous. You're not in a coding war zone. Tone matters – avoid 8) _____ communication that can be misunderstood. Emojis and polite phrases go a long way. And hey, everyone's got a life – respect 9) _____. Don't DM your teammate at midnight just because you feel productive.

If someone's gone quiet, give them a polite 10) _____. Maybe they forgot. Maybe they're dealing with life. Either way, don't assume the worst.

A strong online presence isn't about being loud – it's about being useful, kind, and human.

Task 5. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Discuss the questions below.

- What should you do if someone is posting off-topic messages in the group chat? How can you politely get them to stay on topic?

2. Have you ever seen someone write in ALL CAPS in a chat? How did it make you feel? What would you do if someone kept using ALL CAPS?
3. What can happen if someone starts to overpost in the group chat? How can you politely tell them to reduce their posts?
4. Have you ever experienced flaming in a chat? How did you handle it? What can you do to stop someone from flaming others?
5. What is ghosting in an online group? How would you feel if someone suddenly stopped replying without any explanation?
6. Have you ever experienced a typing delay in an online chat? How can you politely explain a delay if you need more time to reply?
7. What should you do if you notice someone is lurking in the chat without saying anything? How can you encourage them to join the conversation?
8. Why is it important to avoid tone-deaf communication in online chats? How can you make sure your tone is clear and polite?
9. How can you respect someone's boundaries in an online group? What should you do if someone asks you not to message them outside certain hours?
10. What is a polite way to nudge someone who has not responded to your message in the group chat? How can you ask them without being annoying?

SPEAKING

Task 6. DISCOVER. Answer the questions of the questionnaire honestly to assess your online communication habits. This will help you understand how well you follow netiquette in online study groups or chats. Discuss your results with a partner.

Netiquette Self-Assessment

1. When joining a heated debate in a forum, you:
 - A. Stay respectful and cite sources
 - B. Share opinions but avoid personal attacks
 - C. Respond emotionally, but later regret it
 - D. Post aggressive comments to "win" the argument
2. How do you handle typos in your messages?
 - A. Edit immediately if spotted
 - B. Apologize if someone points it out
 - C. Ignore small errors
 - D. Rarely check for typos
3. Have you ever "ghosted" a message or left a group chat without explanation?
 - A. Never
 - B. Rarely, I try to respond or explain
 - C. Occasionally, if I'm too busy
 - D. Yes, I sometimes stop replying without saying anything
4. In professional chats, how often do you use emojis/slang (e.g., "LOL")?
 - A. Never (keep it formal)
 - B. Occasionally (to lighten the mood)
 - C. Frequently (match the group's style)
 - D. Always (prefer casual language)
5. If someone misunderstands your message, you:
 - A. Clarify politely and apologize
 - B. Explain without apologizing
 - C. Let others interpret it as they wish
 - D. Argue that your message was clear
6. How do you respond to repetitive questions in forums?

- A. Politely link to previous answers
 - B. Answer briefly
 - C. Ignore them
 - D. Reply with sarcasm
7. When giving feedback on someone's work, you:
 - A. Use constructive language and examples
 - B. Focus on positives but avoid criticism
 - C. Point out flaws bluntly
 - D. Avoid giving feedback altogether
 8. In forums, do you use your real name or a pseudonym?
 - A. Always real name
 - B. Real name in work chats, pseudonym elsewhere
 - C. Pseudonym to stay anonymous
 - D. Use fake names everywhere
 9. If a colleague shares sensitive info in a chat, you:
 - A. Report it to a moderator
 - B. Privately remind them to delete it
 - C. Ignore it
 - D. Share it with others
 10. Do you tend to lurk in online group chats?
 - A. Never, I always participate actively
 - B. I try to contribute regularly
 - C. Sometimes, I prefer to listen first
 - D. Yes, I often just observe without saying anything
 11. If someone doesn't respond to your message, do you nudge them politely?
 - A. I never nudge, I wait patiently
 - B. I usually wait for them to reply on their own
 - C. Sometimes, I nudge if it's urgent
 - D. Yes, I nudge them frequently until they respond
 12. Do you tend to overpost in group chats?
 - A. Never
 - B. I try to avoid overposting
 - C. Sometimes, if I have many things to share
 - D. Yes, I often send multiple messages in a row

Interpretation of Results

Mostly A's: Proactive Professional

You prioritize clarity, respect, and privacy. Your habits reflect strong netiquette awareness and leadership in digital spaces.

Mostly B's: Adaptable Communicator

You balance formality and friendliness but may overlook minor rules. Increase consistency in citing sources and conflict resolution.

Mostly C's: Casual Participant

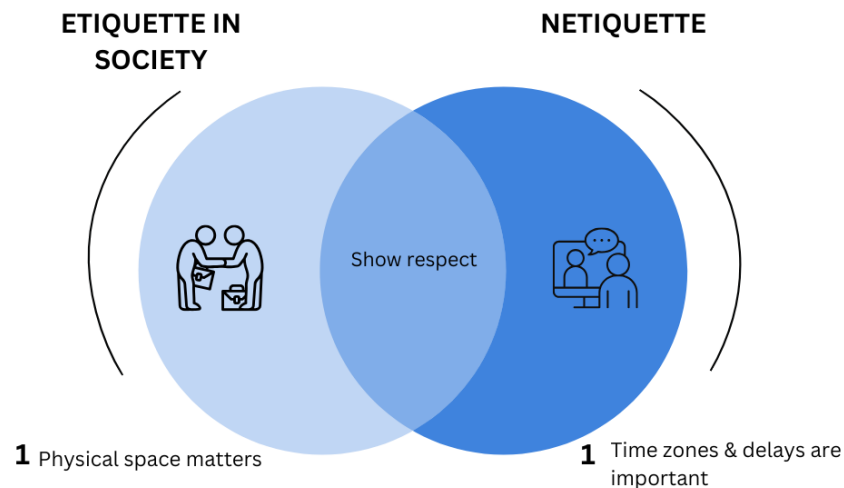
You engage informally and avoid conflict but risk misunderstandings. Focus on proofreading and forum guidelines.

Mostly D's: High-Risk User

Your habits may harm your reputation or others (e.g., aggression, sharing sensitive info). Seek guidance on digital ethics and professionalism.

Task 7. COLLABORATE. Work in pairs or small groups. Create a Venn diagram to compare etiquette in society and netiquette. Think about behaviors, tools, and consequences. Use the guiding questions to help you fill it out.

- What behaviors are considered polite or impolite?
- What tools or platforms are involved?
- What happens when someone breaks the rules?
- Where are the rules written or learned?



Task 8. COLLABORATE. Work in groups of 3-4 students. Play a card game. Follow the rules:

- Shuffle all the cards (abbreviations + definitions).
- Deal all cards equally among players.
- Each player holds their cards in a hand.
- The youngest player goes first by placing one abbreviation card face-up in the center.
- The player who has the correct matching definition puts it on top of the abbreviation.
- After a correct match, the player who placed the definition starts the next round.
- The first player to get rid of **all their cards** wins!

Abbreviations Game

BRB	Be right back	BTW	By the way
FYI	For your information	IMO / IMHO	In my opinion / In my humble opinion

IDK	I don't know	TBH	To be honest
LOL	Laughing out loud	ROFL	Rolling on the floor laughing
TTYL	Talk to you later	AFK	Away from keyboard
OMG	Oh my god / goodness	DM	Direct message
NSFW	Not safe for work	TL;DR	Too long; didn't read
TMI	Too much information	ICYMI	In case you missed it
NVM	Never mind	SMH	Shaking my head

FTW	For the win	ETA	Estimated time of arrival
FAQ	Frequently asked questions	ASAP	As soon as possible
YOLO	You only live once	OOO	Out Of Office

Task 9. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Read each online comment and decide if the comment is Polite or Impolite. If it's Impolite, rewrite it to make it more respectful.

Online Comment	Polite / Impolite?	Polite Version (if needed)
1. You obviously have no idea what you're talking about.		
2. Thanks for explaining your point. That helped me understand.		
3. OMG. This is the dumbest thing I've read all day.		
4. I disagree, but that's an interesting perspective.		
5. No one cares. Just stop posting.		
6. Could you give more info on that? Sounds cool.		
7. LOL you're totally wrong, do some research.		
8. I see your point, but I have a different opinion.		
9. Stop wasting everyone's time.		
10. That's a good suggestion. Let me think about it.		

Task 10. COLLABORATE. Work in groups of three. Read the situation below. You are a digital investigation team. You have been called to analyze the situation. Your goals are to:

1. Check the evidence (digital clues below)
2. Build a theory of what happened

3. Decide: Was it Elena? Was her account hacked? Or could AI tools have been used to mimic her style?

A student named Elena K. reported that a harmful and offensive comment appeared on her school's tech forum under her account. The post was shared publicly and caused a wave of angry reactions. Elena claims she never wrote the post. She says she was studying offline at that time and only found out when she received messages from classmates. The IT team checked her account and found no sign of hacking but something strange appeared in the logs...

Student A: You are a metadata analyst. Examine timestamps, devices, and login activity.

Student B: You are a cybersecurity officer. Evaluate account security, passwords, location data.

Student C: You are a language specialist. Compare writing style in the post to Elena's real posts

Clues

1. Clue 1
Forum Post (appeared at 16:42)
"Anyone who thinks group projects are fair clearly doesn't do the real work. Time to name the lazy ones."
The post uses sarcasm and casual slang.
It sounds like Elena's writing but harsher.
2. Clue 2
Login History (Elena's account)
16:42 – Post created
Device: Chrome browser on Windows
IP address: matches Elena's home Wi-Fi
Login method: auto fill password
Same browser used at 15:55 (school research)
3. Clue 3
Previous Text Samples (by Elena)
"I think group work can be OK if everyone tries."
"Sometimes it's hard when people don't participate, but I talk to them directly."
4. Clue 4
New AI Tool Rumor
One of Elena's classmates says she once showed them how to use an AI post assistant to rewrite emails and forum replies. The app remembers writing style and can auto-compose messages.

Task 11. ANALYZE. Read the case study and discuss possible solutions to the problem.

A group of university students is working on a shared coding project. They've been using a team chat to stay in touch, nothing fancy, just messages back and forth. One of the guys, Erik, started writing in ALL CAPS a lot. It looked as if he was just excited when he figured something out and wanted to make it stand out. But it didn't land that way. A few people on the team started feeling uncomfortable because to them it felt like Erik was shouting all the time. After a while, they stopped reacting to his messages, even though, to be fair, a lot of his suggestions were actually useful. The problem is that Erik doesn't see what the big deal is. He thinks people are ignoring him for no reason. The others are frustrated too, but no one's really said anything directly. The project's slowing down, and the atmosphere's just awful.

What could they do to clear things up and make the chat space feel more respectful for everyone?

LISTENING

Task 12. LISTEN FOR DETAILS. Scan the QR code and listen to people talking about their experiences with video calls. Complete the table.



	Maya	Edward	Sofia
1. What do they use video calls for?			
2. What do they like about video calls?			
3. What do they find difficult about video calls?			
4. What's one rule or habit they follow?			
5. What advice do they give for better video calls?			

Work in pairs. Answer the same questions about your video calls.

WATCHING

Task 13. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Decide if the behavior during video calls is acceptable ("Do") or unacceptable ("Don't"). Discuss your opinion. Use the phrases below to help you express your ideas.

Useful Phrases

- I think it's okay if...
- That's unprofessional because...
- In a casual meeting, maybe it's fine, but...
- I would feel uncomfortable if someone...
- That depends on the situation. For example, if...

Do or Don't?

Behavior	"Do" or "Don't"?	Your Reason
1. Turning off your camera for the whole meeting.		
2. Eating a sandwich during the call.		
3. Joining the meeting 10 minutes late.		
4. Using a funny background with dancing cats		
5. Not muting your mic while someone else is speaking.		
6. Sending private jokes in the group chat.		
7. Wearing pajamas in a video call.		
8. Talking over someone to make your point.		
9. Having a pet walk across your keyboard on camera.		
10. Checking your phone while others are talking.		
11. Saying nothing for the entire meeting.		
12. Asking questions in the group chat instead of speaking.		
13. Using the "Raise Hand" button before speaking.		

Task 14. WATCH FOR DETAILS. Scan the QR code and watch the video called “Online meetings” which tells about netiquette during video calls. Choose the correct answer for the questions below.



1. Why should you join the meeting a few minutes early?
 - A. To check who else is joining
 - B. To test your connection and get ready
 - C. To chat informally with others
2. What kind of background is recommended for online meetings?
 - A. A background with decorations
 - B. A virtual beach background
 - C. A background with no distractions
3. How should your image be framed on the screen?
 - A. From the chest up
 - B. From shoulders up, with space above your head
 - C. Close-up of your face
4. What should you do with your phone before joining the meeting?
 - A. Use it for taking notes
 - B. Keep it in hand in case of messages
 - C. Set it to silent and leave it aside
5. Why is it important to turn on your video at the start of a meeting?
 - A. It shows you're present and respectful
 - B. It helps you see yourself better
 - C. It improves sound quality
6. What are participants in big meetings advised to do?
 - A. Introduce themselves at the beginning
 - B. Keep their microphones muted
 - C. Use emojis to respond
7. In small group meetings, what is one suggested way to begin?
 - A. Ask a question about the topic
 - B. Make a joke to lighten the mood
 - C. Say hello and introduce yourself
8. What is one reason you shouldn't type during a video call?
 - A. It makes noise that's hard to mute
 - B. It can affect your camera and concentration
 - C. It causes the computer to overheat
9. Which of the following is suggested while speaking in a meeting?
 - A. Use gestures frequently
 - B. Speak fast to save time
 - C. Be clear, slow, and patient
10. What should you do at the end of an online meeting?
 - A. Close the window silently
 - B. Say a polite goodbye
 - C. Turn off your camera first

Task 15. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Role play short dialogues using the situations below. Take turns to switch roles.

Student A: You are a host of an online meeting.

Student B: You are a participant who breaks video call etiquette in different ways.

Useful Phrases for the Host:

- Would you mind muting your mic?

- Could you please turn your camera on?
- Let's take turns speaking.
- Can you try to find a quieter space?
- Maybe save the snack for after the meeting?
- Let's stay focused on the topic.

Situations:

1. Talking over others constantly.
2. Having loud music or background noise.
3. Arriving late and not apologizing.
4. Eating loudly during the call.
5. Leaving the camera off without explanation.
6. Using distracting filters or backgrounds.
7. Walking around with the phone during the call.
8. Typing loudly while others are speaking.
9. Not responding when someone speaks to you.
10. Playing with your phone while others are presenting.

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Task 16. STUDY AND ANALYZE. Look at the rule about modal verbs of ability, study in what situations they are used.

MODALS OF ABILITY

USE	MODAL	EXAMPLE
Expressing ability now or generally	can	I can write polite emails.
Expressing decisions made now about future ability	can	We can have an online meeting tomorrow.
Expressing ability in the past	could	I could use online forums before I learned about netiquette.
Expressing ability in present, future or general hypothetical situations	could	If only I could stop checking my notifications every five minutes!
Expressing ability in past hypothetical situations	could+perfect infinitive	I could have replied more politely, but I was in a hurry.
For the infinitive and other tenses	able to	I'd love to be able to write better emails. (infinitive) I'll be able to moderate group chats after training. (future) I've been able to spot phishing emails since last year. (present perfect)
Expressing past ability for one occasion	was/ were able to	He was able to deescalate the heated discussion in the group chat. (=He managed to deescalate ...)
Expressing repeated past ability.	could	She could always recognize sarcasm online.
With verbs see, hear, feel, smell, taste, understand, remember and guess.	could	They could understand why clear subject lines are important. (They were able to understand..)

Task 17. PRACTICE. Match the two parts of the sentences.

1. He could have avoided the argument...	a) but instead, they ignored the issue for days.
2. If she had checked the link before posting,...	b) if they had verified the information first.
3. The moderator could have deleted the post...	c) if they had taken the time to research the topic.
4. They could have responded to the complaint earlier,...	d) before it caused a lot of controversy.
5. If the website had better security,...	e) it couldn't have been hacked so easily.
6. The influencer could have warned their followers...	f) but he was too busy moderating other discussions.
7. If the admin had been online,...	g) she wouldn't have spread false information.
8. The user could have shared more reliable sources,...	h) the offensive comments couldn't have remained visible for so long.

Task 18. PRACTICE. Circle the correct word or phrase. If both are correct, circle both.

1. You **can't** / **couldn't** send emails without a subject line, **can** / **could** you?
2. We **can** / **could** schedule a virtual meeting tomorrow if you're available.
3. I wish I **can** / **could** reply faster to emails, then **I'd be able to** / **I could** respond immediately.
4. I'm afraid we **can't** / **won't be able to** edit the post once it's published.
5. Thankfully, we **could** / **were able to** recover the deleted forum messages.
6. Sarah **could** / **can** have replied politely instead of ignoring the message.
7. Would you like to **could** / **be able to** moderate the group chat?
8. In the future, **can AI** / **will AI be able to** detect cyberbullying in online discussions?
9. We could **delete** / **have deleted** the offensive comment immediately, but we didn't notice it.
10. Everyone **could** / **was able to** recognize that the message was sarcastic.

Task 19. PRACTICE. Fill in a verb from the box in the correct form in each gap.

delete ▪ post ▪ edit ▪ moderate ▪ reply ▪ do ▪ check ▪ share ▪ ignore ▪ write ▪ warn

1. It seems there's nothing anybody can _____ to stop the spread of fake news.
2. She couldn't _____ to the message for hours because the platform was down.
3. I don't think the admin will ever be able to _____ the offensive comments in time.
4. Can I _____ this link in the group chat? It's really useful.
5. Sam didn't react to the rude comment, so why can't I _____ it too?
6. If the message violates the rules, you can't _____ it without consequences.
7. Dominic had said he knew how to _____ emails professionally, but his response was too informal.
8. I'd love to be able to _____ an article about netiquette online, but I don't have time.
9. The moderator tried to _____ the user about their inappropriate language.
10. A forum assistant can _____ your posts if you make a mistake.
11. We couldn't _____ the chat settings because the admin locked them.

UNIT 4.2 CYBERBULLYING

LISTENING

Task 20. LISTEN FOR DETAILS. Scan the QR code and listen to the report about cyberbullying. Match the sentences to the correct figures or percentages mentioned in the listening. There are extra numbers you do not need to use.



1. The percentage of teens who faced cyberbullying in the past month.
2. The percentage of adults who have experienced online harassment.
3. The percentage of teens who felt scared after being cyberbullied.
4. The percentage of female teens affected by cyberbullying.
5. The number of teens who missed school due to cyberbullying.

15%	26.5%	2023
60%	41%	2021
50%	1 in 5	13%
23.2%	1 in 4	

Task 21. LISTEN FOR DETAILS. Listen to the report again. Decide whether the following statements are True, False, or Not Given.

1. Cyberbullying only affects teenagers.	True / False / Not Given
2. Girls are more likely to be cyberbullied than boys.	True / False / Not Given
3. TikTok is the most common platform where cyberbullying happens.	True / False / Not Given
4. Adults are often victims of false rumors online.	True / False / Not Given
5. Most teens feel happy after being cyberbullied.	True / False / Not Given
6. The number of teens skipping school because of cyberbullying is rising.	True / False / Not Given
7. Cyberbullying statistics have improved since 2021.	True / False / Not Given
8. The report gives advice on how to stop cyberbullying.	True / False / Not Given

READING AND VOCABULARY

Task 22. READ FOR DETAILS. Read the text about cyberbullying. Answer the questions below.

Understanding Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying now is more than just rude comments online, it can take many forms and have a lasting emotional impact on victims. One of the things that makes it so difficult is how it can invade private spaces. A person might be having a normal day and suddenly get hit by a wave of hurtful comments or public shaming that seems to come out of nowhere. Unlike traditional bullying, which often stops when you leave the room or walk out of school, cyberbullying tends to follow you home. The things people post online can remain accessible for weeks, months, or even years, long after the original event. And when posts go viral, the emotional impact is multiplied. It becomes not just a bad day, but something you carry with you.

Cyberbullying refers to deliberate, repeated, and harmful behavior carried out through digital platforms like social media, messaging apps, gaming chats, and forums. It includes harassment, threats, exclusion, public shaming, and spreading false information.

Common types of cyberbullying include:

- **flaming** – posting angry, aggressive, or insulting messages in a public forum.
- **outing** – sharing someone’s private or embarrassing information without their permission.
- **exclusion** – deliberately leaving someone out of a group chat, game, or online activity.
- **impersonation** – pretending to be someone else to damage their reputation or relationships.
- **cyberstalking** – sending threatening messages or following someone’s online activity obsessively.
- **trolling** – posting provocative or offensive content to upset others and cause conflict.
- **doxxing** – publishing someone’s personal information, like address or phone number, without consent.

The psychological toll of cyberbullying can be severe. Victims often experience:

- Anxiety and depression
- Low self-esteem
- Social withdrawal
- Sleep disturbances
- Academic decline or decreased job performance

In serious cases, especially when the bullying involves repeated public shaming or threatening messages, people can begin to withdraw socially and even develop signs of depression. Sadly, there are situations where long-term abuse has been linked to self-harm or suicidal thoughts.

Unlike face-to-face bullying, there’s no safe place to hide. Victims may feel powerless, isolated, and constantly monitored. This kind of online abuse can lead to a sense of helplessness, where individuals feel they can’t escape the situation no matter what they do.

If you see cyberbullying, don’t stay silent as most people do. They either don’t know how to help, or they don’t want to become a target themselves. But saying nothing often allows cyberbullying to continue. Being an upstander, someone who speaks up or supports the victim, can make a huge difference. Everyone deserves to feel safe, respected, and valued, both offline and online.

(adapted from <https://www.unicef.org/end-violence/how-to-stop-cyberbullying>)

1. What is cyberbullying?
2. How is cyberbullying different from traditional bullying?
3. Give two examples of cyberbullying from the text.
4. Why can cyberbullying have a worse impact than face-to-face bullying?
5. What emotional problems can victims of cyberbullying experience?
6. What is ‘outing’ in cyberbullying?
7. What is a possible result of long-lasting cyberbullying?
8. Who is an ‘upstander’?

Task 23. WORK WITH WORDS. Find in the text and match the two parts of collocations.

1. stay	a) disturbance
2. go	b) false information
3. sleep	c) private spaces
4. emotional	d) silent
5. invade	e) accessible
6. public	f) self-esteem
7. remain	g) toll
8. spreading	h) viral
9. psychological	i) shaming
10. low	j) impact

Task 24. WORK WITH WORDS. Match a type of cyberbullying to a situation.

Types of Cyberbullying	
1. flaming	a) Liam discovered that someone created a fake profile pretending to be him and started messaging his classmates with rude comments.
2. outing	b) A girl in class secretly recorded a private video call and shared the clip in a group chat to embarrass her classmate.
3. exclusion	c) A student was constantly left out of group messages and not invited to join the class's online gaming group.
4. impersonation	d) Daniel kept posting mean, sarcastic comments under a YouTube video to make the content creator angry.
5. cyberstalking	e) Jason received disturbing messages late at night from the same unknown person, who seemed to know his every move online
6. trolling	f) Someone hacked Mia's social media and sent insults to her friends from her account
7. doxxing	g) A teenager posted another student's full name, address, and school name on a public forum during an argument.
8. harassment	h) Every day, Max receives spam messages full of insults and threats from the same group of people on his messenger app.

Task 25. COLLABORATE. Work in small groups. Discuss which three forms of cyberbullying you think are the most damaging for victims. Explain your reasoning and compare your results with another group.

Task 26. WORK WITH WORDS. Read the text and fill in the missing words.

The Caroline Flack Tragedy

continued ▪ trolling ▪ movement ▪ comments ▪ suicide ▪ kindness ▪
conversation ▪ post ▪ rumours ▪ affected

Caroline Flack was a well-known British TV presenter. In the years before her death in 2020, she received a lot of online 1) _____. Strangers on social media often sent her cruel 2) _____, judged her personal life, and spread negative 3) _____. The online hate 4) _____ even when she was going through a difficult time in her private life.

Caroline spoke about how the negative comments 5) _____ her mental health. Sadly, she died by 6) _____ in February 2020. Her case shocked many people and started a national 7) _____ about cyberbullying, mental health, and 8) _____ online. The hashtag #BeKind became a 9) _____ to remind others to think before they 10) _____.

Task 27. COMMUNICATE. Work in groups. Discuss the following questions together.

1. Why do you think people post negative comments about celebrities online?
2. How do you think Caroline felt when she read these messages?
3. Do you think social media companies should do more to stop trolling? Why or why not?
4. What can we do to support someone who is being trolled?
5. What does “#BeKind” mean to you? Can kindness really make a difference online?

Task 28. THINK CRITICALLY. Fill in the table with missing ideas. Compare the two types of bullying. Match the correct ideas to the correct cells.

Aspect	Face-to-face bullying	Cyberbullying
Visibility	1. _____	2. _____
Location	3. _____	4. _____
Anonymity	5. _____	6. _____
Duration of impact	7. _____	8. _____
Audience reach	9. _____	10. _____
Examples	11. _____	12. _____
a) Usually happens in places like schools or offices b) Can happen anytime, even at night or at home c) Usually visible to people nearby d) Bully is often someone the victim knows e) Bully can hide behind a fake name or account f) Ends when the victim leaves the place g) Hurtful content can stay online for a long time h) Few people are involved i) Can go viral and seen by many people j) Hitting, pushing, or name-calling in person k) Mean messages, edited photos, or online rumors l) May be hard for adults to notice		

Task 29. EXPLORE THE IDIOMS. Study the meaning and examples of IT related idioms. Then use them in sentences.

Keep your nose clean – to stay out of trouble.

*Follow netiquette to **keep your nose clean** in digital spaces.*

Stir the pot – to provoke or cause trouble, often in online forums.

*Trolls love to **stir the pot** with inflammatory comments.*

Caught red-handed – to be caught in the bad acts.

*The cyberbully was caught **red-handed** posting fake profiles.*

Fish in troubled waters – to take advantage of chaos.

*Hackers **fish in troubled waters** during online arguments.*

Clean slate – a fresh start, often digitally after a breach or bad behavior.

*After the incident, she wanted a **clean slate** online.*

Walk on eggshells – to act cautiously.

*With cyberbullying risks, we **walk on eggshells** in chats.*

Push someone's buttons – deliberately annoy or provoke someone

*Cyberbullies often **push people's buttons** just to get a reaction.*

Fill in the gaps with the correct idiom from the list above. Each idiom is used only once. Sometimes you may need to change the form of the verb.

1. After spreading rumors online, he was _____, banned from the forum instantly.
2. To avoid drama, she decided to _____ and avoid posting anything controversial.
3. The scammer tried to _____ when the chatroom erupted into a heated debate.
4. The bully kept posting comments to _____ and make her angry.
5. That user always _____ by starting fights in the comments section every week.
6. She typed carefully, feeling like she had to _____ to avoid upsetting anyone.
7. After the data leak, he created a new profile, hoping for a _____ online.

Task 30. COMMUNICATE. Work individually or with a partner to narrate the story aloud. Tell the story of a teenager's first big online mistake and how they recover from it. Describe the turning point. Use at least two idioms naturally.

Task 31. COLLABORATE. Work in pairs. Imagine a social media platform crashing due to trolls, and how users and moderators respond. What happens next? Discuss with your partner how the trolls cause chaos and how people fix it. Use at least three idioms in your scenario.

Task 32. WRITE. Write a short, funny story about two students caught up in a digital citizenship blunder, like a viral prank gone wrong. Use the idioms above.

WATCHING

Task 33. WATCH FOR DETAILS. Scan the QR code and watch the video “Cyberbullying Effects”. Fill in the gaps in the table.



Aspect	Cyberbullying Facts
Definition	The use of online communication to harass, threaten or 1) _____ someone.
Common platforms	Most common are on 2) _____ sites and messaging apps.
Anonymity	People can remain anonymous on social media, which makes it easier for them to be mean or 3) _____.
Victim emotions	Common feelings include sadness, anger, fear, and 4) _____.
Mental health effects	Victims may suffer from depression, anxiety, and 5) _____ thoughts.
Academic impact	Cyberbullying can lead to difficulty concentrating and 6) _____ grades.
Physical effects	Can include headaches, stomach aches, and 7) _____ problems.
Impact on witnesses	Witnesses may feel scared, 8) _____, and sad.
Proofs	Victims should keep 9) _____, like screenshots of bullying messages.
Taking action	Victims should 10) _____ the bullying to the platform where it happened.

Task 34. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Answer the questions below.

1. What are some examples of cyberbullying mentioned?
2. Why has cyberbullying become more common in recent years?
3. What are some differences between bullying on social media and in direct messages?
4. How can online games be used for cyberbullying?
5. How can cyberbullying affect someone's relationships or trust in others?
6. Why might witnesses feel helpless or scared?
7. Do you think cyberbullying is a serious problem in your country?

SPEAKING

Task 35. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Sort out victims' and upstanders' reactions and responses.

Victim or Upstander?

1. Please stop posting things like that. It's hurtful.
2. Deletes all their social media accounts.

3. Saves screenshots of the messages and reports the bully.
4. Pretends nothing happened and stays silent.
5. Messages the victim to say, "Are you okay? I'm here if you want to talk."
6. Blocks the bully but tells no one.
7. Publicly defends the victim with a kind comment.
8. Changes their name online to avoid being found.
9. Says, "It's probably my fault. I shouldn't have posted that."
10. Shares a positive message online to support others.
11. Joins in and laughs at a mean post to avoid being bullied too.
12. Encourages others to report the bullying too.
13. Cries alone and avoids going online.
14. Asks a teacher or adult for help.
15. Posts a story saying cyberbullying is never okay and everyone deserves respect.

Task 36. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Choose one victim reaction and one upstander response from the list above. Act out short dialogues.

Student A: You are a victim.

Student B: You are an upstander.

Task 37. COLLABORATE. Divide in two teams. Team 1 reads a concern or a negative statement about cyberbullying. Team 2 must respond with a supportive or constructive message, using a phrase from the list. Each team takes it in turn to make statements and to answer. The answers must be introduced by one of the phrases from the list. Each team has 10 seconds to answer. Play two or three rounds' with each round lasting 5 minutes.

EMPATHY AND ACTION

Phrases:

That's true, but we can...
 I agree, and that's why it's important to...
 Yes, and one way to help is...
 Absolutely, so we should...
 That's why we need to...
 That's a big problem, but we can take steps like...
 Very true, and that's when support matters most.
 I hear that, and it shows why...
 Good point, and people should...

Statements:

1. Cyberbullying can happen anytime, even at night.
2. It's hard to know who the bully is when it's anonymous.
3. A single post can go viral and humiliate someone.
4. Victims often feel alone and don't talk about it.
5. Some people think online bullying isn't as serious as real-life bullying.
6. It's difficult to delete harmful content once it's posted.
7. Bullies often don't face real consequences.
8. Social media platforms don't always react fast enough.
9. Reporting bullies doesn't always stop the behavior.
10. Cyberbullying can seriously affect someone's mental health.
11. Some people don't even realize their jokes are hurting others.
12. People are scared to speak up when they see cyberbullying.

Task 38. COLLABORATE. Work in small groups to read five cases about cyberbullying, decide which problem you sympathize with most, and share your personal experiences. Discuss the questions below.


sarahlee


Toxic Group Chat At Work

My coworkers created a group chat to plan a team event, but they started sharing offensive memes about me, mocking my appearance. I saw it by accident, and now I feel isolated at work. I don't know how to confront them.







89 replies 157 likes


moradund


Hateful Messages After Presentation

I gave a presentation in my university class, and afterward, someone anonymously sent me hateful messages on Instagram, calling me stupid and saying I don't belong here. It's humiliating, and I'm scared to speak up in class now.







125 replies 1056 likes


laurasmith


Discrimination On Social Media

I posted about my promotion at work on one company, and a group of people started leaving discriminatory comments about my gender, saying I only got it because I'm a woman. It's so unfair, and I'm thinking of deleting my account.







58 replies 566 likes


danielbrown


Threats After Debate Club Event

I spoke at a university debate club event, and after sharing my opinion online, I got threatening messages from strangers, including my address - they somehow found it! I'm terrified and don't feel safe on campus anymore.







90 replies 877 likes


markwilliams


Fake Profile Ruining My Reputation

Someone made a fake social media account using my name and photo, posting embarrassing content about me. I'm applying for internships, and now I'm worried recruiters will see it and think it's me. I feel so helpless.







85 replies 106 likes

1. Which of the five situations is the most severe, and why?
2. Which situations seem solvable, and what advice would you give to resolve them?

3. What would you do if in one of these situations, escalate or resolve yourself?
4. As a university professor or platform administrator, what actions would you take if this happened on your platform or within your university?

Task 39. COLLABORATE. Work in small groups. Read about a real cyberbullying case. Talk about why people didn't help and what we can do to make people speak up online. Discuss the questions below.

Amanda Todd

In 2012, Amanda Todd, a 15-year-old girl from Canada, died by suicide after being bullied online for many years. When Amanda was 12, a stranger on the internet made her share a private photo. Later, he used the photo to scare and control her. The photo was shared on social media, and people started sending Amanda mean messages and creating fake profiles to make fun of her. Many people saw the bullying, but most didn't help. Some even shared the photo or wrote cruel comments. Amanda made a video on YouTube where she talked about her pain and problems. Sadly, the bullying didn't stop, and she died one month later.

1. Why do you think many people didn't help Amanda?
2. How did people who shared the photo or posted mean comments make Amanda feel worse?
3. If you saw this happening online, what would you do to help Amanda?
4. What things might stop you from helping?
5. Imagine you are a teacher or someone who works for a social media website. What rules or ideas could help people stand up to bullying online?

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Task 40. STUDY AND ANALYZE. Look at the rule about modal verbs for offers and permissions, study in what situations they are used.

MODALS FOR OFFERS, REQUESTS AND PERMISSIONS

USE	MODAL	EXAMPLE
Permission		
Asking for, giving and refusing permissions	can / can't (informal)	You can't post mean comments online.
	could (more polite)	Could I report an abusive message to the moderator?
	may (formal)	You may block someone if they harass you.
	might (more formal)	Might I ask you to delete that rude post?
	can't / mustn't (informal)	You mustn't share private messages without permission.
	may not (formal)	Users may not send threats or spread rumors.
	wasn't allowed, couldn't	He wasn't allowed to use the forum after being reported.
Requests and Offers		
Asking and offering	will (very friendly)	Will you help me report this bully?
	would you mind (polite)	Would you mind explaining why my post was deleted?
	can (informal)	Can I/we do anything for you?
	Shall (informal)	Shall we create an anti-cyberbullying campaign?

	Would you like me	Would you like me to show you how to report abuse?
--	-------------------	---

Task 41. PRACTICE. Circle the correct word in each sentence.

1. Victims of cyberbullying **may not** / **mustn't** be left without support from teachers and parents.
2. You **can't** / **couldn't** post harmful comments about others online – it's against the rules.
3. **Will** / **Might** I report an anonymous case of cyberbullying to the school administration?
4. Students **can** / **shall** seek help from a counselor if they feel threatened online.
5. **Would you mind** / **Shall** reporting that abusive message to the moderator?
6. If you experience cyberbullying, you **can** / **may** block the bully and report their account.
7. **Can** / **Shall** I help you file a complaint against the cyberbully?
8. Teachers **weren't allowed** / **couldn't** see private messages exchanged between students without permission.
9. **Would you like me** / **Will you** talk to the principal about the online threats you received?
10. **Can** / **Mustn't** I post a comment defending my friend from online bullies?

Task 42. PRACTICE. Match each request (1-10) with the correct response (A-J).

1. Can you help me report a cyber bully?	a) Of course! I'll show you the steps.
2. May I block someone who keeps sending me mean messages?	b) Sure! I know how to make your accounts more secure.
3. Could I talk to the university counselor about online harassment?	c) Absolutely, the counselor will be happy to help.
4. Would you mind checking my privacy settings for me?	d) That's a great idea! Let's organize a meeting.
5. Shall we create a support group for students facing cyberbullying?	e) Not at all! I'll help you adjust your settings now.
6. Would you like me to help you secure your social media accounts?	f) Yes! We can raise awareness and encourage responsible online behavior.
7. Can I share a screenshot of a bullying message with a professor?	g) Of course, let's report it together.
8. Might I remain anonymous when reporting online abuse?	h) Yes, you can report anonymously to avoid revenge.
9. Could you show me how to disable comments on my posts?	i) Yes, if it helps provide evidence, you should report it.
10. Can we do anything to stop cyberbullying at our university?	j) Yes, blocking them is a good way to stop the harassment.

Task 43. PRACTICE. For each situation, write 1–3 sentences using appropriate modal verbs (can, could, may, might, mustn't, would, shall, etc.) to express requests, offers, or permissions.

1. A student asks for permission to remain anonymous when reporting cyberbullying.
2. A professor offers to support a student who is being bullied online.
3. A student asks the IT department for help with a hacked university email account.
4. A gamer asks a moderator to ban a player who is harassing others online.
5. A coworker asks if they can share screenshots of workplace bullying with HR.
6. A manager offers to help an employee who is experiencing online harassment.
7. An employee asks HR for permission to report cyberbullying from a coworker.
8. A student politely asks a classmate to remove an embarrassing post about them.

UNIT 4.3 DIGITAL FOOTPRINT

READING AND VOCABULARY

Task 44. EXPLORE THE WORDS. Read the sentences and try to understand the bold words from the context. Match the words with their definitions.

1. Every time you go online, you leave a **trail** of your activity that others may be able to follow.
2. Liking a post or uploading a photo is an **intentional** act – you know you are doing it.
3. A passive footprint is created without your direct **input**, like when a website tracks your location.
4. Your online behavior can **shape** how people view you, especially future employers.
5. What someone finds online can influence their **judgment** about your character.
6. Sharing too much personal data online can make you **vulnerable** to hackers.
7. **Identity theft** can happen when someone uses your personal data to access your accounts.
8. Many people find targeted ads **invasive**, especially when they are based on private data.

- a) _____ (adj) done on purpose; planned.
- b) _____ (n) a path or series of marks left behind.
- c) _____ (n) something that is added or entered into a system.
- d) _____ (v) to influence or determine the way something develops.
- e) _____ (adj) affecting someone's privacy in an unwanted or uncomfortable way.
- f) _____ (n) the illegal use of someone's personal data to pretend to be them.
- g) _____ (adj) easily hurt, harmed, or attacked.
- h) _____ (n) the ability to make considered decisions or come to sensible conclusions.

Task 45. READ FOR DETAILS. Read the text and answer the questions below.

What You Leave Behind Online

Every time you log on, click a link, or tap “like,” you leave behind a mark – a trace of your presence. This invisible trail is known as your digital footprint. It records your activity across the internet, from the pages you read to the videos you share. You may not always see it, but this footprint can say a lot about you.

There are two main kinds of digital footprints: active and passive.

An active digital footprint is made up of the things you post or share on purpose. Writing a tweet, updating your status, posting a photo, commenting on a YouTube video, or searching for something on Google. These are all examples of actions you choose to take. Each one leaves a record.

In contrast, a passive digital footprint forms without you doing much at all. Let's say a website tracks your location using GPS, remembers what you searched last week, or collects your browsing habits through cookies, that's your data being recorded silently. Most people don't even realize that things like their IP address, device type, and browser settings are stored each time they connect to the internet.

Your digital footprint can include:

- Your likes, comments, and shares on social media
- The websites you visit and what you search for
- The apps you use and when you log in
- Online shopping activity and saved wish lists
- GPS data showing where you've been

Why should you care? Because the information you leave behind can be seen, collected, and sometimes used in ways you didn't expect. Your digital footprint can influence how you're

perceived by employers, schools, advertisers, and even strangers. Positive online behavior can work in your favor, while careless posts or photos might do the opposite.

There's also a privacy risk. The more you reveal, the easier it becomes for hackers to misuse your data. Identity theft, targeted ads, and cybercrime all feed on digital traces. Some companies track what you like and buy just to tailor ads to your habits. That can feel invasive and often is.

Managing your digital footprint starts with awareness. Be thoughtful about what you share, where you click, and how much of yourself you leave online. Because once something is out there, it might never fully disappear.

(adapted from <https://www.kaspersky.com/resource-center/definitions/what-is-a-digital-footprint?>)

1. Why is your digital footprint important?
2. What is an active digital footprint? Give two examples.
3. What is a passive digital footprint? Give two examples.
4. Which type of footprint includes GPS tracking and cookies: active or passive?
5. What are four kinds of information that are part of your digital footprint?
6. How can your search history become part of your digital footprint?
7. What kind of devices and data can websites and apps collect from you?
8. Why can your digital footprint be dangerous for your privacy?
9. How can your digital footprint affect your future job or university application?
10. Why do you think many people don't realize how much information they share online?

Task 46. WORK WITH WORDS. Fill in the gaps in the text with the words from the box.

Take Control of Your Digital Life

consent ▪ clickstream ▪ tracked ▪ permissions ▪ oversharing ▪ unsecured ▪
inappropriate ▪ permanent ▪ targeted ▪ scrub ▪ uploading

Nowadays, every click, search, and like adds to your 1) _____ – a detailed record of your online activity. This information can be used to send you 2) _____ ads based on your behavior and interests. While it may seem convenient, it also increases the risk of being 3) _____ online.

To stay safe, always review app 4) _____. Many apps ask for access they don't need, and allowing 5) _____ access to your data can lead to privacy issues. Another smart step is to manage your privacy settings through 6) _____ management tools. These help you decide what data you want to share and with whom.

Be especially careful when using an 7) _____ connection, like public Wi-Fi. Hackers can easily steal your personal information. Also, remember to think twice before 8) _____ photos, comments, or videos. Everything you post is 9) _____, even if you delete it later. But it's still a good idea to 10) _____ your old posts from time to time and remove anything that might affect your future.

One more thing: monitor your digital reputation. Employers and schools often search for you online. A single 11) _____ post can damage your chances. So, avoid 12) _____ on social media – not everyone needs to know where you are or what you're doing every moment.

Task 47. WORK WITH WORDS. Match the words to their definitions.

1. clickstream	a) when your activity or location is followed and recorded online
2. scrub	b) companies other than the user that may gain access to your data
3. permissions	c) the process of posting content to a website or social platform
4. tracked	d) when ads are shown to specific users based on their behavior or interests
5. third-party	e) the ability an app or site has to access your data, like camera, location, etc.
6. permanent	f) agreement for your data to be collected or shared

7. unsecured	g) staying online forever
8. uploading	h) to remove or clean up old or harmful digital content
9. consent	i) a full list of the websites and pages a user visits while browsing online.
10. targeted	j) unsafe internet connection that can expose your data to hackers
11. inappropriate	k) posting too much personal or private information
12. oversharing	l) not suitable for a certain audience or situation.

WATCHING

Task 48. WATCH FOR MAIN IDEA. Scan the QR code and watch the video “Digital Footprint”. Choose the best summary of the video.



- The video discusses how your digital footprint helps advertisers find out what you like and how you feel. It explains how websites use this data and suggests deleting your accounts to stay private.
- The video explains how your online actions shape your digital footprint. It gives tips on how to manage your online reputation by adjusting privacy settings, checking what’s online about you, and thinking carefully before posting.
- The video focuses on how students use digital tools every day and how universities track student activity. It gives examples of how university administrators use digital footprints to improve education and limit app access.

Task 49. WATCH FOR DETAILS. Watch the video again and choose the correct answers to the questions.

- What is a digital footprint?
 - A mark left by a tracking cookie
 - A record of your online activity
 - A list of your computer files
 - A footprint created by typing online
- What happens to information once it is posted online?
 - It can be automatically deleted after a week
 - It becomes invisible unless someone searches
 - It cannot be fully erased
 - It disappears when the device is turned off
- What is one benefit of a positive digital footprint?
 - It helps reduce online advertisements
 - It builds a strong personal brand
 - It deletes negative search results
 - It increases privacy on social media
- How can your digital footprint affect your future?
 - It can help you save storage space
 - It influences how you look in photos
 - It affects your eligibility for bank loans
 - It can impact job or university applications
- How can you find out what your digital footprint says about you?
 - Ask a friend to check your profile
 - Search for your name in a search engine
 - Log in as a guest on social media
 - Change your IP address regularly
- Why is it important to adjust privacy settings on apps and websites?

- A. To make your account look more active
 - B. To save battery life on your device
 - C. To control who sees your information
 - D. To update your contact list automatically
7. What are cookies in the context of online activity?
 - A. Data that helps websites remember your actions
 - B. Small digital images that block ads
 - C. Temporary email accounts
 - D. Passwords stored by your browser
 8. What is one risk of accepting all cookies automatically?
 - A. You might increase your digital footprint
 - B. Your browser may slow down
 - C. You will lose internet connection
 - D. Your screen resolution might change
 9. Why should you “think before you share” online?
 - A. Because posts may use up mobile data
 - B. Because shared content becomes part of your permanent footprint
 - C. Because it can make the internet slower
 - D. Because it might increase your follower count
 10. What’s the general goal of managing your digital footprint?
 - A. To get better online shopping deals
 - B. To limit how long you spend on the internet
 - C. To make sure your online presence reflects who you are
 - D. To be able to delete your profiles every week

LISTENING

Task 50. EXPLORE THE WORDS. Match the words from the audio you are going to listen to their definitions.

1. audit profiles	a) to control what you share online by selecting content with care
2. curate posts	b) emotional changes that happen quickly and often
3. geotagging	c) to evaluate or review online accounts and data
4. profiling	d) to spread or move around on the internet
5. cringeworthy	e) marking photos or posts with a location
6. online credibility	f) stored and listed in a search engine’s results
7. circulate	g) reputation or how trustworthy you seem online
8. mood swings	h) to remove or delete digital content
9. leak	i) when private or sensitive information becomes public
10. indexed	j) behavior analysis based on someone’s online activity
11. escalate	k) causing embarrassment or second-hand shame
12. erase	l) to grow or become more intense

Task 51. LISTEN FOR DETAILS. Listen to the audio "How My Digital Footprint Affected Me". You will hear five different people talking about their experiences. Read the questions below and decide which speaker (Speaker 1–5) each statement refers to. Write the number of the speaker next to each question.

Which speaker ...



1. realized that even deleted posts can continue to spread?	Speaker 1 (Mark)
2. learned the dangers of sharing their real-time location?	
3. was shocked to find an embarrassing forum post still visible online?	Speaker 2 (Leila)
4. realized the consequences of an old meme still circulating online?	
5. experienced online arguments that damaged their reputation?	Speaker 3 (Ethan)
6. turned off geotagging features on their social apps?	
7. discovered that their 'likes' could influence job opportunities?	Speaker 4 (Zara)
8. had to contact a website admin to remove content?	
9. mentioned the concept of profiling for the first time?	Speaker 5 (Jamal)
10. started auditing and curating their online profiles regularly?	

SPEAKING

Task 52. COLLABORATE. Work in small groups. Consider the following online activities and discuss their impact on your digital footprint. Mark each as either positive, negative, or depends on context. Be ready to explain your choices.

- Posting personal photos on public social media
- Using strong passwords and two-factor authentication
- Sharing your location in real time
- Liking or commenting on posts with political content
- Using a private browser (Incognito Mode)
- Sharing memes or jokes without checking the source
- Accepting all cookies on websites
- Deleting old accounts you no longer use
- Posting achievements and skills on LinkedIn
- Using your real name on gaming or discussion platforms

Task 53. COLLABORATE. Work in pairs. Read the two short opinions below and answer the questions.

Message from a Student

I never really thought about my digital footprint until my teacher mentioned it. I used to post everything online – photos, jokes, opinions – without thinking. One day, I Googled myself and was shocked to see how much was visible. Now I try to clean up my accounts and think twice before posting. I believe everyone should learn how to manage their digital identity.

Message from a Recruiter

When we look at job applicants, we often check their online presence. It gives us an idea of who they are. A professional-looking profile can help someone stand out. But if we find inappropriate posts or aggressive comments, it raises red flags. Your digital footprint really matters – it can open doors or close them.

1. Who realized they were sharing too much online, and what did they do about it?
2. How does the recruiter use digital footprints when selecting candidates?
3. What advice do both people seem to agree on?

Task 54. COLLABORATE. Work in pairs. Decide if the following statements are True or False.

1. The student believes their digital footprint had no effect on their life.
2. The recruiter uses digital footprints to help choose between job candidates.
3. The student didn't change their behavior after seeing what they had shared online.
4. Both speakers agree that managing your online image is important.
5. The recruiter ignores digital footprints when making decisions.

Task 55. COMMUNICATE. Discuss these questions in pairs or small groups.

1. Do you think your current digital footprint would help or hurt you in a job interview? Why?
2. What are some ways people can protect their digital privacy?
3. Have you ever posted something online that you later regretted?
4. Should schools or universities teach students about digital footprints? If yes, what topics should they cover?
5. Do you think people worry too much or too little about their digital footprints? Why?

Task 56. COMMUNICATE. Work in pairs. Read each scenario and discuss:

- Would you post it? Why or why not?
- What are the possible consequences of posting it?
- How might it affect your digital reputation?

1. A selfie with friends at a party where alcohol is visible.
2. A joke that might be misunderstood or considered offensive by some people.
3. A post sharing your live location while on vacation.
4. A rant about your teacher or boss after a bad day.
5. A work ID badge clearly showing your name and position.
6. A comment on a controversial political or social issue.
7. A screenshot of a private message you found funny.
8. A post about skipping university or lying to your employer.
9. A review of an app or company using very harsh or emotional language.
10. A funny video of your friend that they don't know you recorded.
11. A photo with someone who's no longer your friend, with a sarcastic caption.
12. A meme that stereotypes a group of people, but you think it's "just a joke".
13. A public request for help (e.g., "Can anyone lend me money?" or "Feeling depressed...").
14. A giveaway post asking for personal details in the comments (like birthday or email).
15. A personal achievement (like winning a competition or getting a job offer).

Task 57. COLLABORATE. Choose one worksheet and go around the class asking each other questions from the worksheet in second person (Do you?). If you get an affirmative answer, note the name of the student who said 'yes'. Discuss the results with the class.

Worksheet 1	Name
Find someone who	
Googled their own name recently.	
Thinks everything you post online stays there forever.	
Has reviewed app permissions on their phone this month.	
Believes targeted ads are creepy.	
Has deleted old or inappropriate social media posts.	
Has posted something they later regretted.	
Avoids using unsecured Wi-Fi.	
Thinks it's easy to be tracked online.	
Uses different passwords for different websites.	
Has seen their photos shared without permission.	
Clicks "I agree" without reading privacy policies.	
Feels overwhelmed by their digital footprint.	

Worksheet 2	Name
Find someone who	
Has seen someone being cyberbullied.	
Reported an offensive post or comment online.	
Believes online insults can hurt as much as real ones.	
Knows what to do if they experience online harassment.	
Avoids commenting on sensitive topics online.	
Has talked to someone about being bullied online.	
Always thinks twice before uploading a photo.	
Reminds others to follow netiquette in group chats.	
Avoids oversharing personal info on social media.	
Knows how to block or mute someone online.	
Has helped a friend deal with cyberbullying.	
Has participated in a discussion about digital ethics.	

Task 58. COLLABORATE. Work in pairs. Look at different short online profiles. For each one, discuss the questions below.

- What impression does this person give based on their posts, likes, and photos?
- Would you trust this person? Why or why not?
- How could this profile affect their future job or university application?
- What could be improved to create a more positive digital footprint?

What Impression Does This Profile Give?

Profile A

Posts mostly memes, jokes, and sarcastic comments. Comments on others' photos with laughing emojis and "cringe" remarks. No personal info or professional posts.

Profile B

Shares lots of vacation photos, selfies, and food pictures. Frequently checks into expensive restaurants and tags luxury brands. Follows only celebrities.

Profile C

Posts regular updates about volunteering, coding projects, and tech events. Occasionally shares opinions about social issues with respectful tone.

Profile D

Often reposts controversial opinions without fact-checking. Uses strong language in comments and argues with strangers online. Rarely shares anything personal or professional.

Profile E

Has a very private profile – no visible posts, photos, or friends list. Uses a cartoon as a profile picture. Only one or two posts from years ago, mostly about hobbies.

Profile F

Posts TikTok and Instagram stories daily. Shares challenges, pranks, and dance videos. Sometimes includes personal details like school location and home neighborhood.

1. Which profile do you think is most aware of their digital footprint?
2. Which one might face problems with netiquette or privacy?
3. How would you change your own profile if a future employer was looking at it?

Task 59. ANALYZE. Read the case study and discuss possible solutions to the problem.

Max is an IT student and recently he applied for a competitive internship at a well-known software company. He'd done the coding test, had the interview, and honestly felt like it had gone

better than expected. It wasn't a sure thing, of course, but he figured he at least had a decent shot. So when the rejection email showed up in his inbox, he was very surprised. A little confused, Max followed up and asked if they could share any feedback. That's when he found out the issue wasn't with his tech skills. The recruiters had checked his public social media and found a bunch of old posts from when he was about 16. Stuff like strong opinions, memes about hating deadlines, and jokes about burnout. He didn't even remember posting most of it, but it was still out there for anyone to see.

What can students do to stay on top of their digital footprints and avoid problems like this when applying for jobs or internships?

WRITING

Task 60. WRITE. Write a formal complaint letter (100–120 words) to the admin of a group chat or online platform where digital citizenship rules were violated. Choose one situation: rude and offensive messages, flooding the chat and ignoring rules, sharing private messages without consent, mocking a beginner's question, ignoring moderator warnings.

Use the model and include the following points:

- Describe when and where the incident happened.
- Describe the inappropriate behavior (e.g., rude comments, personal attacks, ignoring netiquette rules).
- Say how it affected you or the group.
- Politely request that the situation be reviewed and appropriate action taken.

Useful phrases:

- I am writing to complain about...
- This behavior is unacceptable and unprofessional.
- I kindly request that you...
- I hope this issue will be addressed...
- I look forward to your reply.

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Task 61. STUDY AND ANALYZE. Look at the rule about modal verbs for obligation, necessity and prohibition, study in what situations they are used.

MODALS FOR OBLIGATION, NECESSITY AND PROHIBITION

USE	MODAL	EXAMPLE
Current or general obligation and necessity	must, mustn't, have (got) to, need (to)	You must think before posting personal details online.
A lack of current or general obligation and necessity	don't have to, haven't got to, needn't, don't need (to)	You don't have to share your full name on social media.
Future obligation and necessity	will have to, must, mustn't, have (got) to, (will) need (to)	You ll have to update your privacy settings often.
A lack of future obligation and necessity	don't/won't have to, haven't got to, needn't, don't/won't need (to)	You won't have to delete old posts manually if you use auto-delete.

Past obligation and necessity	had to, needed (to)	People had to be extra careful online before privacy laws existed.
A lack of past obligation and necessity	didn't have to, didn't need (to), needn't + perfect infinitive	She didn't need to use strong passwords years ago, but now she does. (It wasn't necessary) You needn't have shared your phone number – it was already online. (It wasn't necessary but you did)
Prohibition	mustn't, can't	You mustn't share your work password with others.

Task 62. PRACTICE. Fill in **must** or **have to**.

Must → When the speaker personally feels something is necessary because of responsibility, urgency, or strong advice.

Have to → When the necessity is imposed by an external rule, policy, or authority.

Emma: Hey, Jake. Have you seen the new company policy on social media use?

Jake: No, what's new?

Emma: Well, we 1) _____ be careful about what we post online, especially if it mentions the company. Also, we 2) _____ follow strict rules for sharing company-related content.

Jake: What about emails?

Emma: We 3) _____ use strong passwords to protect our accounts. The IT department also said we 4) _____ change them every three months.

Jake: And file sharing?

Emma: We 5) _____ avoid sending confidential files through personal email accounts. Instead, we 6) _____ use the company's secure platform.

Jake: Do we 7) _____ delete personal posts that mention work?

Emma: No, but we 8) _____ include a disclaimer saying our views are personal.

Jake: If we notice a security issue, do we 9) _____ report it?

Emma: Yes, and if it's serious, we 10) _____ report it immediately to IT.

Task 63. PRACTICE. Fill in the gaps with **didn't need to** or **needn't have** and the correct form of the verb in brackets.

- I deleted my old social media posts, but I _____ (worry) so much because my profile was already private.
- We _____ (share) that personal information online; now it's everywhere!
- Since the website had automatic fact-checking, the journalist _____ (verify) every detail manually.
- Mike _____ (set) a strong password again because he already had two-factor authentication enabled.
- You _____ (post) that comment about your boss – it could have serious consequences.
- Emma _____ (report) that rude message because the platform had already removed it.
- The teacher _____ (warn) students about digital footprints again, as they had already completed a course on online privacy.

8. Since I had scheduled my social media posts in advance, I _____ (log) in over the weekend.
9. We _____ (download) that app – it was full of malware!
10. He _____ (apologize) publicly for the misunderstanding, but he did anyway to clear his reputation.
11. Lisa _____ (delete) her entire account when she could have just adjusted her privacy settings.
12. They _____ (share) their location in the group chat; we already knew where to meet.

Task 64. COMMUNICATE. Read the situations below and discuss what actions people **must/must not/have to/don't have to** take. Use modal verbs to explain your reasoning.

1. You accidentally share a misleading post about a cybersecurity threat, and it starts spreading quickly.
 - What must you do to correct the mistake?
 - Do you have to apologize publicly?
 - What must not you do to avoid making the situation worse?
2. Your friend is being cyberbullied in a group chat. The messages are hurtful, and other people in the group are encouraging the behavior.
 - What actions do you have to take to support your friend?
 - What must people or social media platforms do in response?
 - Do you have to report the bully, or is it optional?
3. A university student submits an essay written by AI without making any changes. The professor finds out.
 - What academic rules must students follow regarding AI tools?
 - Do students have to disclose AI assistance in their work?
 - What penalties must universities enforce for plagiarism?
4. A company hires people to write fake positive reviews about its services. A customer notices the reviews seem dishonest.
 - What ethical standards must businesses follow?
 - Do companies have to be honest in their advertisements?
 - What actions must not they take to manipulate online reviews?
5. Someone creates a fake social media account using the company's name and starts posting misleading information.
 - What must the company do to stop this?
 - What must not customers do before verifying online sources?
 - Do social media platforms have to help in such cases?
6. A rival company spreads false rumors about your company's products to make customers lose trust.
 - What must your company do to protect its reputation?
 - Do companies have to respond to every false claim?
 - What must not companies do when defending themselves?